

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**Why is it important to follow a tested pectin manufacturer's recipe exactly when making freezer jams?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Different pectin brands have unique preparation methods that are not interchangeable.**

## FUN FACT

*Using the wrong pectin or recipe can result in a runny or grainy freezer jam.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



**Q**

**What is the recommended headspace to leave in jars when canning hot jams or jellies?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**1/4 inch**

## FUN FACT

*Proper headspace helps ensure a good vacuum seal and prevents jar breakage.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**At what temperature (relative to boiling water) should jam or jelly mixtures be cooked to ensure proper gelling?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**220°F or 8°F above boiling point of water**

## FUN FACT

*Gelling temperature depends on elevation and is critical for the right texture.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**Why should recipes for jams and jellies never be doubled unless specifically allowed?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Doubling can prevent proper sugar dissolution and cause runny or grainy gel.**

## FUN FACT

*Large batches can be harder to cook evenly and gel properly.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What protects high-sugar elderberry jams and jellies from botulism despite elderberries being low acid?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**The high sugar concentration reduces water activity to prevent *Clostridium botulinum* growth.**

## FUN FACT

*Sugar acts as a preservative by lowering available moisture in jams.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What is a key difference in making freezer jams compared to traditional cooked jams?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Freezer jams are not cooked; they rely on pectin, sugar, and fresh fruit mixed at room temperature.**

## FUN FACT

*Because freezer jams aren't cooked, they have a fresh fruit flavor.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**Which jar size is recommended for best setting of home canned jams and jellies?**



## ANSWER

### Half-pint or pint jars

## FUN FACT

*Large jars cool more slowly and may cause jams to not gel properly.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What method is suggested to test if a jam mixture has reached the gel stage without a thermometer?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Place a small amount on a cold plate in the freezer and see if it gels after a few minutes.**

## FUN FACT

*The cold plate test is a classic way to check gel formation at home.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What is the main reason jams and jellies with reduced sugar may have a softer texture and less flavor?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Sugar promotes gel formation and acts as a preservative in jams and jellies.**

## FUN FACT

*Special pectins are required to gel jams with low or no sugar.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**How long should jars be processed in a boiling water canner for jams at elevations above 6,000 feet?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**15 minutes**

## FUN FACT

*Processing time increases with elevation to ensure safety.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**Why is sugar important in the preparation of freezer jams besides sweetness?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Sugar helps dissolve fruit juices and is required for gel formation.**

## FUN FACT

*Sugar also helps preserve the jam by lowering water activity.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What should you do to jars before filling them with hot jam to ensure safe canning?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Sterilize jars by boiling for 10 minutes and keep them warm.**

## FUN FACT

*Warm sterilized jars reduce jar breakage and contamination risks.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What is the usual headspace to leave when canning syrups compared to jams or jellies?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**1/2 inch for syrups, 1/4 inch for jams and jellies**

## FUN FACT

*Headspace allows for expansion and proper sealing during processing.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What should you do if a jam or jelly recipe uses low-methoxyl pectin for low-sugar products?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Follow recipe instructions closely; these pectins gel without sugar but may take time to set.**

## FUN FACT

*Low-methoxyl pectin allows making jams with less or no sugar safely.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**If you want to make jam without added pectin, what is the best choice of fruit?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Use firm, slightly under-ripe fruit which naturally contains pectin.**

## FUN FACT

*Natural pectin is highest in underripe fruit, which helps jams set without added pectin.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What should you do immediately after filling jars with hot jam before processing?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Wipe jar rims, adjust lids, and process in a boiling water canner.**

## FUN FACT

*Wiping rims prevents jams from interfering with sealing during processing.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home





**Q**

**How long can freezer jams maintain good quality when stored frozen?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Up to one year**

## FUN FACT

*Freezer jams can be conveniently stored for a year but must be refrigerated after opening.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What is the main reason to avoid doubling freezer jam recipes?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Large batches make it hard to dissolve sugar and can cause grainy texture.**

## FUN FACT

*Small batches help ensure even sugar distribution and good gel.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**What is the recommended thickness test for jams when cooking without added pectin?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Cook until thickened and use the cold plate test or thermometer at 220°F**

## FUN FACT

*Cooking longer concentrates natural pectin and sugars to achieve gel without additives.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

**Q**

**Why do jams and jellies often require processing in boiling water canners except freezer jams?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Adults

## ANSWER

**Boiling water processing ensures a safe vacuum seal and destroys spoilage microorganisms.**

## FUN FACT

*Freezer jams are not processed because they are stored frozen immediately after making.*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home